CONSTITUTION

The Centre's Constitution establishes its institutional purpose, governance structure, delegated authority and research framework. Its accompanying policies provide detailed standards for data protection, intellectual property, confidentiality, research integrity, records and implementation. The adopted Constitution and approved policies will be made available here, with their effective dates and subsequent revisions. This page provides an overview. The adopted governing documents, applicable law and executed project agreements determine the detailed rights and obligations of the Centre and its participants.

OBJECTIVES

Advance Original and Independent Research

Provide a platform for legal professionals, students and eligible interdisciplinary researchers to undertake original, methodologically sound legal and technology research. Encourage critical inquiry, careful evaluation of sources and conclusions supported by evidence and reason.

Support Legislative and Policy Development

Examine the design, interpretation, administration, enforcement and effectiveness of laws and public policies. Identify statutory gaps, regulatory uncertainty and implementation challenges, and develop practical proposals for reform.

Examine Technology and Its Legal Implications

Investigate the legal, ethical and governance implications of artificial intelligence, automated decision-making, emerging technologies, data privacy, cybersecurity and digital activity. Contribute to approaches that protect rights while supporting responsible innovation.

Develop Research Across Legal Disciplines

Advance inquiry into intellectual property, technology transfer, corporate and commercial law, mergers and acquisitions, competition law, litigation and dispute resolution. Address constitutional, administrative, civil, criminal, social and economic questions of contemporary importance.

Strengthen Research Skills Through Mentorship

Conduct structured short-term, mid-term and long-term legal and technology research programmes with transparent proposal-based selection, supervision, defined milestones and assessed outputs. Develop researchers' capabilities in methodology, ethical research, legal writing and policy communication, with stipends and research support on approved project-specific terms.

Encourage Informed Debate and Consultation

Create opportunities for reasoned discussion of contested legal and policy questions through consultations, lectures, seminars, workshops and scholarly exchanges. Welcome competing viewpoints and encourage constructive engagement among researchers, practitioners, institutions and other stakeholders.

Publish and Share Accessible Research

Publish research papers, articles, reports, policy briefs and educational resources that communicate findings clearly and support informed decision-making. Maintain appropriate editorial review, respect intellectual property rights and acknowledge researchers' authorship and contributions.

Build Academic and Institutional Collaboration

Collaborate with academic institutions, professional bodies, researchers, public institutions and other suitable organisations. Support joint inquiry, knowledge exchange, policy consultation and capacity building while preserving scholarly independence.

Promote Public Understanding and Access to Justice

Make legal, technology and policy research accessible to wider audiences. Examine barriers to justice and institutional effectiveness, and contribute to public understanding of rights, responsibilities and legal processes.

Uphold Integrity and Institutional Accountability

Maintain standards of intellectual honesty, fairness, inclusion, confidentiality, data protection and responsible use of technology. Manage conflicts of interest and apply grants, donations and other permitted resources transparently towards the Centre's public-benefit objectives.

GOVERNANCE AND INSTITUTIONAL POLICIES

Satatham Kritam Advanced Legal Technology and Imperative Research (SK ALTAIR) is committed to academic independence, responsible research and transparent institutional administration. Our governance framework supports rigorous scholarship while maintaining accountability for the use of funds, the protection of information and the conduct of research. SK ALTAIR operates as a non-profit unit of Sri Chennakeshava Memorial Education and Welfare Society. The Centre functions through the Society within its lawful objects, governing documents and approved delegations of authority.

OUR GOVERNANCE STRUCTURE

Governing Council

The Governing Council provides academic direction and oversees the Centre's research activities. Within its delegated authority, the Council determines:

- Research priorities, topics, programme calls and candidate selection.
- Appointment of supervisors and reviewers, research methodology and academic standards.
- Editorial policies and publication decisions, with safeguards for independent research conclusions.
- Project expenditure within the approved annual budget and financial limits.
- Academic collaborations and research partnerships within approved institutional arrangements.

The Council also monitors programme delivery, research quality, conflicts of interest and compliance with institutional policies.

Centre Leadership and Academic Functions

The Centre's leadership coordinates programme administration, researcher communications, supervision, milestones and institutional reporting. Academic committees, editorial boards, supervisors and independent reviewers support research quality and publication standards. Designated officers oversee privacy, information security, intellectual property and grievance handling, with responsibilities structured to avoid conflicts of interest.

Role of the Society

The Society retains responsibility for legal compliance, financial oversight, statutory records and matters reserved under its governing documents. These include approval of the Centre's Constitution and annual budget, specified appointments and commitments requiring the Society's authorisation. Contracts, grants and institutional rights are undertaken or held through the Society for the Centre's purposes. The Council's academic and operational authority is exercised within this framework.

Academic Independence

Research must be guided by evidence, sound methodology and reasoned analysis. Donors, collaborators and institutional stakeholders may propose research questions and contribute perspectives, but must not dictate findings or require predetermined conclusions. We welcome constructive criticism of laws, policies and institutional practices. Scholarly disagreement alone should not determine selection, assessment or publication decisions. Publication decisions remain subject to applicable law, research ethics, confidentiality, privacy and intellectual property obligations. Authors' views do not automatically constitute an adopted institutional position.

OUR INSTITUTIONAL POLICIES

Research Integrity and Ethics

Researchers must uphold originality, intellectual honesty and accuracy throughout their work. Sources must be acknowledged, research methods explained and findings presented fairly, including relevant limitations and contrary evidence. Plagiarism, fabrication, falsification and misleading attribution are unacceptable. Research involving interviews, personal information, vulnerable participants or other sensitive matters requires appropriate assessment and safeguards before it begins.

Responsible Use of Artificial Intelligence

AI tools may support research where permitted by project terms and institutional policy. Researchers remain responsible for the accuracy, originality and integrity of their submissions. Material use of AI must be disclosed as required. AI-generated legal propositions, citations and factual statements must be independently verified. Confidential information, unpublished work and personal data must not be entered into unapproved AI systems.

Data Protection and Information Security

We are committed to handling personal information responsibly throughout applications, research programmes, consultations, publications and institutional administration. Our framework addresses purpose-specific collection, appropriate notices and permissions, restricted access, secure storage, retention and deletion, service-provider controls and incident response. Research involving personal data is subject to additional assessment where necessary. The website Privacy Notice explains how information collected through the website is handled and how individuals may raise requests or concerns.

[Read Our Privacy Notice]

Confidentiality

Researchers, supervisors, reviewers, personnel and collaborators must protect confidential information entrusted to them. This may include unpublished research, participant information, internal records and material received from third parties. Confidential information may be used only for authorised purposes and shared only through permitted channels. These obligations continue after an engagement ends, subject to applicable terms and lawful exceptions, including protected reporting and disclosures required by law.

Intellectual Property and Publication Rights

Project agreements define ownership, assignment and permitted use of research outputs. Rights assigned for the Centre's purposes are held through the Society in accordance with those agreements and applicable law. Researchers' authorship and contributions must receive appropriate acknowledgement. Background intellectual property and third-party material remain subject to their respective ownership and licensing terms. Publication, reuse and licensing are managed through authorised institutional processes, with appropriate protection for confidential material and potentially protectable inventions.

Editorial Standards and Publication Review

Research outputs are assessed for originality, analytical quality, accuracy, source reliability and relevance. Publication decisions include independent review and checks concerning confidentiality, privacy, intellectual property and research ethics. Where material errors or integrity concerns arise after publication, the Centre may issue corrections, clarifications or retractions following a fair editorial process.

Conflicts of Interest and Funding Independence

Individuals involved in selection, supervision, review, procurement and governance must disclose relevant personal, professional and financial interests. Conflicted individuals must withdraw from affected decisions where required. Funding arrangements must support the Centre's public-benefit purposes and preserve research independence. Material funding influences and relevant interests should be disclosed appropriately.

Fair Participation and Grievance Handling

We seek to provide an inclusive and respectful research environment, with clear selection criteria, documented project terms and fair assessment. Researchers and other stakeholders may raise concerns relating to programme administration, assessment, conduct, confidentiality or policy compliance. Complaints should be reviewed impartially, with an opportunity for affected persons to respond and protection against retaliation for good-faith reporting.

[Contact the Centre Regarding a Grievance]

Programme Accountability and Records

Each research project is governed by written terms covering its scope, duration, milestones, stipend, supervision, submission requirements and completion criteria. Completion certificates are issued only upon satisfactory completion of the required research within the approved period. Extensions are discretionary and subject to the applicable programme terms; participation alone does not establish completion. Institutional records are maintained under an approved retention framework, with controlled access, appropriate preservation and secure disposal.

Constitution and Policy Documents

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Questions About Our Governance

For enquiries about governance, research standards, institutional policies or collaboration requirements, please contact the Centre.

[Contact Us] · [Vision, Mission and Objectives] · [Research Programmes]